DocuQA Cricket
Missing Topics Research Supplement

2026 corpus-expansion document based on official ICC research

Purpose. This document fills the main coverage gaps identified after reviewing the current DocuQA cricket corpus. It is a **research supplement**, not an official replacement for MCC/ICC regulations. For rule conflicts, the current official MCC/ICC source documents should remain authoritative.

Research date: 21 October 2026
Primary authority researched: International Cricket Council (ICC)
Recommended use: Add this PDF as supplementary knowledge, while also adding the official source PDFs listed in the source register.

1. Gap Analysis

The existing corpus is already strong on MCC Laws, men's and women's Test/ODI/T20I playing conditions, major current tournament material, IPL, conduct, anti-doping and general cricket knowledge. The research identified several additional areas that can materially broaden question coverage.

Priority	Missing / underrepresented topic	Why it matters for QA
HIGH	ICC Champions Trophy 2025	Tournament-specific rules, reserve day, venues, DLS, match procedures.
HIGH	ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025	Women's ODI tournament-specific rules and procedures.
HIGH	ICC Women's Championship 2025–29	Women's ODI championship structure and competition rules.
HIGH	Duckworth-Lewis-Stern (DLS)	Detailed rain/interruption target calculations beyond normal playing conditions.
MEDIUM	Men's four-day Test playing conditions	Separate format-specific rules for four-day Test cricket.
MEDIUM	Official-cricket classification / event sanctioning	Answers questions about what constitutes official cricket and sanctioned events.
MEDIUM	Cricket glossary / terminology	Better coverage for technique and vocabulary questions.
OPTIONAL	Rankings/statistics/records	Needed for player/team ranking and statistical questions; highly dynamic.

2. ICC Champions Trophy 2025

The ICC's current Playing Conditions page lists a dedicated **ICC Champions Trophy 2025 Playing Conditions** document. The official document covers tournament-specific playing procedures that are not necessarily identical to a generic ODI description.

Useful QA coverage: tournament structure, playing-area preparation, pitch covering, intervals, reserve-day arrangements, match result procedures, DLS, player eligibility, officials, DRS and tournament-specific operational rules.

The official Champions Trophy document contains detailed provisions for pitch and ground preparation. For example, it specifies requirements for protecting the pitch and surrounding areas during rain and procedures for removal of covers. ■cite■turn0search46■

> **Recommended source to add:** ICC Champions Trophy 2025 Playing Conditions (official ICC PDF). This should be indexed separately rather than relying only on a general ODI document.

Example questions this addition enables

• What were the playing conditions for the 2025 Champions Trophy?
• What were the pitch-cover requirements?
• What tournament-specific procedures applied when play was interrupted?
• How were DLS and reserve-day provisions handled?

3. ICC Women's Cricket World Cup 2025

The ICC provides a dedicated **ICC Women's Cricket World Cup India 2025 Playing Conditions** document. This is an important supplement because a generic women's ODI document describes the format but does not necessarily capture every tournament-specific procedure.

The official tournament document begins with the Spirit of Cricket and is specifically labelled as the Women's Cricket World Cup 2025 Playing Conditions. ■cite■turn0search47■

Recommended QA coverage: tournament format, venues, qualification/competition procedures, match scheduling, reserve-day or interruption provisions, DLS, DRS, officials, player replacement procedures and tournament-specific match rules.

> **Recommended source to add:** ICC Women's Cricket World Cup India 2025 Playing Conditions (official ICC PDF).

Example questions

• What playing conditions applied to the 2025 Women's Cricket World Cup?
• What tournament-specific procedures applied to interrupted matches?
• What were the competition's DRS and match-official provisions?

4. ICC Women's Championship 2025–2029

The ICC's current Playing Conditions page lists both **ICC Women's Championship 2025–2029 Playing Conditions** and separate competition regulations. The July 2026 playing-conditions document is a particularly useful addition to the women's corpus.

The official document covers the International Women's Championship context and includes player, umpire, scorer, ball, bat, pitch, innings, scoring, boundaries, dismissals, conduct and DRS-related provisions. ■cite■turn3view0■

Why it is different: the Women's Championship is a competition structure, not simply another generic ODI match. Questions about championship-specific procedures should be answered from its own regulations/playing conditions.

> **Recommended source to add:** ICC Women's Championship 2025–2029 Playing Conditions and, if broader competition questions are desired, the separate Competition Regulations.

5. Duckworth-Lewis-Stern (DLS)

This is one of the most important missing technical areas. The ICC maintains a dedicated DLS resource and identifies three supporting documents: the DLS Methodology, the Standard Edition table and DLS FAQs. ■cite■turn4view0■

The official methodology explains that DLS adjusts targets according to the relative run-scoring resources available to the two sides. Resources depend on overs remaining and wickets lost, rather than simply scaling the target by the number of overs. ■cite■turn5view0■

The methodology defines resource percentages, calculates resource lost during interruptions, and uses those values to determine a revised target. It also gives worked examples for interruptions during either innings and for multiple interruptions. ■cite■turn5view0■

> **Important implementation note:** do not treat the old Standard Edition table as the modern production calculator. The ICC methodology states that the current ICC DLS calculator is used, with the Standard Edition described as a fallback. ■cite■turn5view0■

Example questions

• What is the DLS method?
• Why do wickets lost affect a revised target?
• What happens when rain interrupts the first innings?
• How is resource percentage lost calculated?
• What is a par score in an abandoned match?

6. Men's Four-Day Test Cricket

The current ICC Playing Conditions page separately lists **ICC Men's Four-Day Test Playing Conditions – October 2026**. This is a distinct format-specific source and should be considered if the system is intended to answer questions about four-day Tests.

This source is especially useful because a normal five-day Test playing-conditions document cannot safely be assumed to answer every four-day Test scheduling or competition question.

> **Recommendation:** add the official four-day Test PDF if your benchmark includes four-day domestic or international Test questions. The ICC currently lists it alongside the October 2026 men's Test, ODI and T20I documents. ■cite■turn0search6■

7. Official Cricket Classification and Event Sanctioning

The ICC also publishes **Classification of Official Cricket – Effective July 2026** and separate regulations governing the sanctioning of cricket events. These are useful for questions about whether a match/event is classified as official cricket or what requirements apply to sanctioned events.

These documents are listed in the ICC's official Playing Conditions / Regulations section alongside playing conditions and integrity regulations. ■cite■turn2view0■

> **Priority:** medium. Add them if your project is intended to answer broader governance and competition questions; they are not necessary for basic cricket-rule QA.

8. Cricket Terminology and General Knowledge

Your existing supplementary documents already provide basic cricket terminology and general knowledge. The remaining weakness is depth and consistency for technical terms such as bowling variations, fielding positions, tactical concepts and specialist jargon.

For a college QA benchmark, a single clean, text-searchable cricket glossary/reference source is preferable to many low-quality scraped or screenshot PDFs. Keep official MCC/ICC documents as the authority for rules; use glossary material for definitions and general explanations.

> **Suggested benchmark categories:** batting terminology, bowling terminology, fielding terminology, scoring terminology, match terminology, tactical terminology and historical terminology.

9. Statistics, Rankings and Records — Keep Separate

A major conceptual gap remains for questions such as 'Who is ranked number one?', 'Who has the most Test runs?' or 'What is the highest ODI score?'. These are not primarily rule-document questions.

ICC rankings are dynamic and are calculated using ranking systems that change as new matches are played. The ICC explains that player rankings use a points-based moving average and that team rankings use format-specific rating calculations. ■cite■turn0search9■

> **Recommendation:** do not create one permanent PDF and call it a complete current statistics database. For your current academic project, either exclude live-statistics questions from the benchmark or create a separate dated statistics corpus with a clear snapshot date.

If you want statistics later, create a separate module such as **Cricket Statistics QA** rather than mixing dynamic ranking data with immutable playing conditions.

10. Recommended Final Corpus Structure

After this research, the cleanest DocuQA corpus is not one giant undifferentiated PDF. Keep authoritative source documents separate during ingestion so the system can return the exact source, page and document type.

Collection	Recommended content
Core Laws	MCC Laws 2026 + official amendments
Men's formats	Test, ODI, T20I, T20 World Cup, WTC, Four-Day Test where needed
Women's formats	Test, ODI, T20I, Women's T20 World Cup, Women's Championship
Tournament-specific	Champions Trophy 2025, Women's Cricket World Cup 2025
Rain / DLS	ICC DLS Methodology + supporting table/FAQ
Regulations	Code of Conduct, Anti-Doping, Anti-Corruption, Anti-Discrimination, equipment, eligibility
Governance	Official Cricket Classification + Event Sanctioning
General knowledge	Clean cricket glossary/history/reference documents
Dynamic data	Separate dated rankings/statistics dataset if desired

11. Source Register

ICC Playing Conditions: official ICC Rules and Regulations / Playing Conditions page. This page currently lists the 2026 men's and women's playing conditions, Women's Championship material, WTC material, Champions Trophy 2025, classification and sanctioning documents. ■cite■turn2view0■

ICC DLS: official ICC Duckworth-Lewis-Stern page, including the methodology, Standard Edition table and FAQ. ■cite■turn4view0■

Champions Trophy: official ICC Champions Trophy 2025 Playing Conditions PDF. ■cite■turn3view1■

Women's Cricket World Cup: official ICC Women's Cricket World Cup India 2025 Playing Conditions PDF. ■cite■turn0search47■

Women's Championship: official ICC Women's Championship 2025–2029 Playing Conditions, effective July 2026. ■cite■turn3view0■

ICC rankings: official ICC rankings and ranking methodology pages. These should be treated as dynamic rather than as a permanent static corpus. ■cite■turn0search5■turn0search9■

12. Final Recommendation for DocuQA

Do not keep collecting random PDFs. Your current corpus already covers the major rules. Add the high-priority sources identified here, then run a 100-question evaluation.

Use the following pipeline for the expanded corpus:

Documents → extraction → preprocessing → chunking → TF-IDF/BM25 → Top-K → extractive QA → evidence validation → answer + source / abstention

The ICC states that its October 2026 playing-condition changes apply to international series beginning on or after 1 October 2026, including measures on batter time-wasting, women's ball specifications and a daytime pink-ball Test trial. Therefore, when your benchmark tests current rules, the effective date of the source must be considered. ■cite■turn0search8■

> **Best next step:** add the official Champions Trophy 2025, Women's Cricket World Cup 2025, Women's Championship 2025–29 and DLS documents. Add Men's Four-Day Test and governance documents if those topics are in scope. Then stop corpus expansion temporarily and measure retrieval failures.